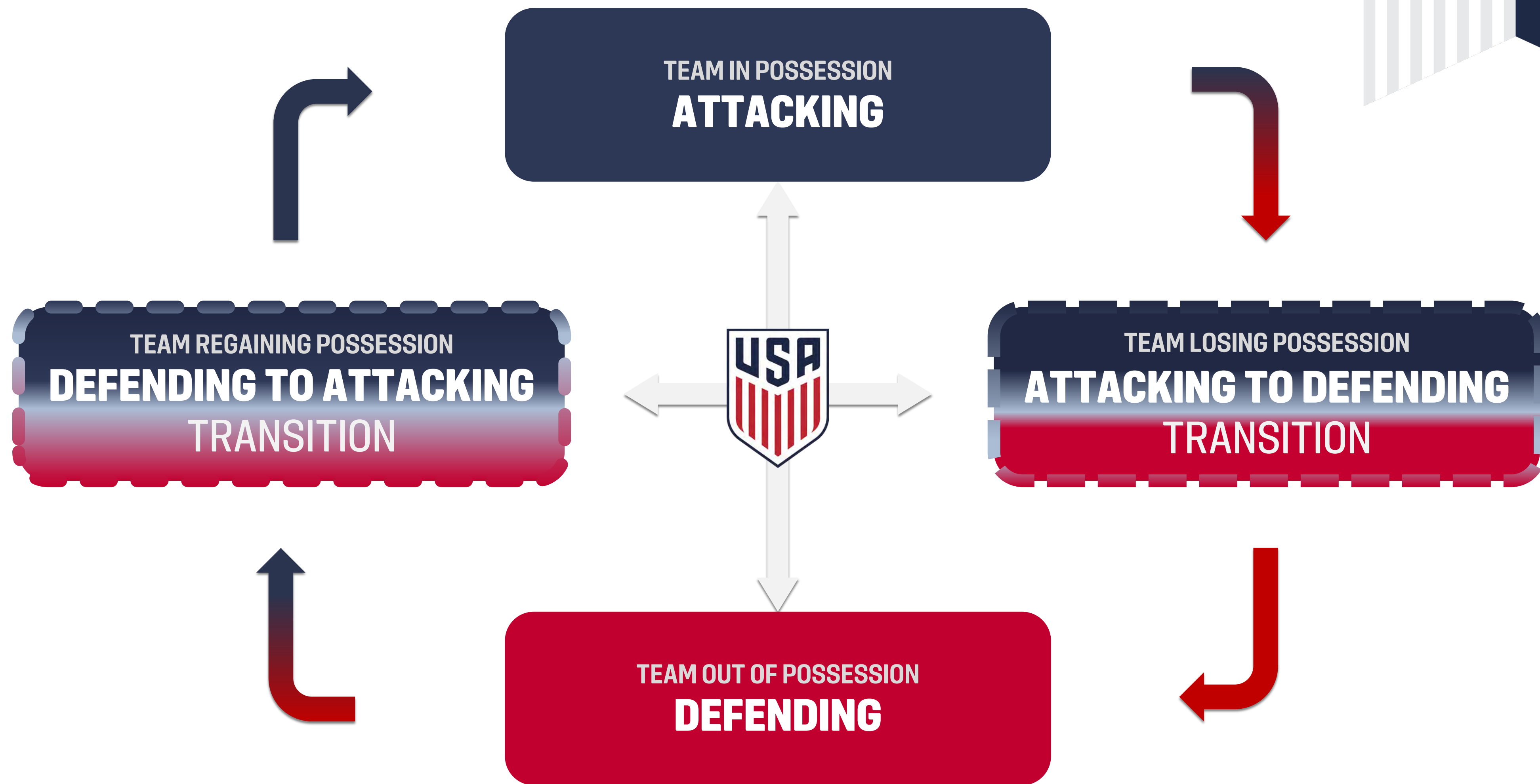




THE GAME MOMENTS





PLAYER DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK

11v11



U15 - U16

PROGRESSION PHASE II
SCANNING, RECEIVING, DRIBBLING, SHORT COMBINATION PLAY AND FINISHING

ATTACKING		
GAME IDEA		
When we have the ball, we want to play forward through individual actions and short combinations, to play in the attacking half in order to create chances and score goals.		
TEAM TACTICAL PRINCIPLES		
MAIN PRINCIPLES	SUB PRINCIPLES	
CREATE ATTACKING TEAM SHAPE	Create appropriate height, width, depth	
	Create optimal attacking distances between players	
PROVIDE OPTIONS TO PLAY FORWARD	Provide vertical or diagonal passing options	
	Overload centrally or wide	
	Move or lose opponent when marked	
	Make runs behind the defensive line	
	Give immediate support to teammate under pressure	
BREAK LINES TO ADVANCE ATTACK	Drive with the ball to exploit space	
	Engage opponent: create 1v1 or 2v1	
	Find a free player between or behind the lines	
	Switch play: pass the ball to opponent's weak zone	
TAKE COUNTERMEASURES: ANTICIPATE OPPONENT COUNTER	Push up the defensive line with speed: stay connected and compact	
	Create high defensive shape behind the ball	
FINISH THE ATTACK AS FAST AS POSSIBLE	Separate: time run or quick movement to unmark	
	Final pass: through ball or combination play	
	Numbers in the box: fill zones in front of goal	
	Cross: into space or player	
	Take on 1v1 to create or score	
	Finish: use limited touches	

U15 - U16		
PROGRESSION PHASE II		
SCANNING, RECEIVING, DRIBBLING, SHORT COMBINATION PLAY AND FINISHING		
ATTACKING		
When we have the ball, we want to play forward through individual actions and short combinations, to play in the attacking half in order to create chances and score goals.		
TEAM TACTICAL PRINCIPLES		
MAIN PRINCIPLES	SUB PRINCIPLES	DEFINITION
CREATE ATTACKING SHAPE POSITION TO STRETCH OPPONENT AND CREATE SPACE	• Create appropriate height, width, depth	• Attacking players position as high as possible: - Pin or move the opponent's back line to stretch the opponent's team in length. - Lower the level of vertical compactness of opponent: - create more space between the opponent's defensive lines (specifically, between the the opponent's back line and midfield). • Wide forwards and/or fullbacks (wide players): - Position wide while avoiding two players in a direct line: position attack across different lanes - Lower level of horizontal (sideline to sideline) compactness of opponent - create more space centrally: creating passing lanes into the opponent's block or - take advantage of space in wide areas • Center backs and/or fullbacks (occasionally midfielders): - Position behind the ball in supporting position. - Lower the level of vertical compactness of opponent: - create enough space to create strong ball circulation - enable a switch of play
	• Create optimal attacking distances between players	• Spread out with optimal passing distance between players. • Create relationships - connections between players. • Exploit space in opponent's defending team shape.

U15 - U16		
PROGRESSION PHASE II		
SCANNING, RECEIVING, DRIBBLING, SHORT COMBINATION PLAY AND FINISHING		
ATTACKING		
When we have the ball, we want to play forward through individual actions and short combinations, to play in the attacking half in order to create chances and score goals.		
TEAM TACTICAL PRINCIPLES		
MAIN PRINCIPLES	SUB PRINCIPLES	DEFINITION
PROVIDE OPTIONS TO PLAY FORWARD (RE-)POSITION TO CREATE ADVANTAGE AND RECEIVE THE BALL	Provide vertical or diagonal passing options	- Exploit the space in and around the opponent's defensive block and create a positional advantage: - Avoid two players in a direct line. - Move and provide a good supporting angle: receive facing forward to play forward when possible. - Stay away from the ball when player on the ball has time and space to play forward. - Triangulate: we position to provide the player on the ball with at least two forward (diagonal/vertical) passing options on different levels of height and width. - Rotate: interchange position to create a dynamic advantage.
	Create overload centrally or wide	- Create a numerical advantage in a specific area of the field: - Position to outnumber opponent in the area around the ball or area away from the ball - Allow more players to attack - penetrations of midfielders or defenders - Drop midfielders or attackers
	Move or lose opponent when marked	- If marked move to <u>open space</u> or move to <u>open the space</u>: - Lose opponent to receive the ball - Distance from defender in space (get unmarked)/ move between the lines - Move opponent to receive the ball - Draw opponent out of defending position to create space for self to receive (requires explosive change of direction) - Move to create space and passing options for teammate to receive - Draw opponent out of defending position to create space for teammate to exploit and receive ball
	Make runs behind the defensive line	- Make run when player on the ball is facing forward and has no pressure or has pressure but can play forward - Use different runs and time run to avoid offside (straight run, curved run, ...) - Receive the ball facing forward
	Give immediate support to teammate under pressure	- Recognize the player on the ball is under pressure and has no immediate options: - Above the ball: move towards the ball to create a passing option - Behind the ball: adjust position to create passing option

U15 - U16		
PROGRESSION PHASE II		
SCANNING, RECEIVING, DRIBBLING, SHORT COMBINATION PLAY AND FINISHING		
ATTACKING		
When we have the ball, we want to play forward through individual actions and short combinations, to play in the attacking half in order to create chances and score goals.		
TEAM TACTICAL PRINCIPLES		
MAIN PRINCIPLES	SUB PRINCIPLES	DEFINITION
BREAK LINES TO ADVANCE ATTACK PROGRESS THE BALL FORWARD AND ELIMINATE OPPONENT(S)	Drive with the ball to exploit space	- Recognize and exploit space. - Accelerate play through dribble: individually progress the ball into space with change of tempo. - Attract opponent (draw attention).
	Engage opponent: create 1v1 or 2v1	- Dribble and look for 1v1 or 2v1 : -Engage to isolate opponent: -Eliminate through dribble: take opponent on in 1v1 -Eliminate through pass or give and go - Move or hold the ball to attract opponent: -Move the opponent, invite pressure to create space for teammate.
	Find a free player between or behind the lines	- Pass quickly, accurately and with appropriate pace to a free player. - Skip a line: recognize opportunity & take risk: look furthest first, look nearest second. - Pass dictates the action: pass with intent.
	Switch play: pass the ball to opponents' weak zone	- Draw opponent to one side and find space on the opposite side: - Direct change of point: long pass - Indirect change of point: short pass
TAKE COUNTERMEASURES: ANTICIPATE OPPONENT COUNTER POSITION TO PROTECT AGAINST COUNTERATTACK	Push up the defensive line with speed: stay connected and compact	- Provide balance (numbers). - We all move with the same speed and lose space in between lines that the opponent could exploit. - Create as high a line as possible. - GK take high position: stay connected with the backline . - GK anticipate long pass from opponent and adjust quickly.
	Create high defensive shape behind the ball	- Defensive positioning by the players who are no longer directly involved in moving the ball forward. - Anticipate losing the ball and occupy positions to defend the opponent's counterattack. -Defend the center of the field: block passing lanes -Lock down the opponent's outlet(s): mark transition players

U15 - U16		
PROGRESSION PHASE II		
SCANNING, RECEIVING, DRIBBLING, SHORT COMBINATION PLAY AND FINISHING		
ATTACKING		
When we have the ball, we want to play forward through individual actions and short combinations, to play in the attacking half in order to create chances and score goals.		
TEAM TACTICAL PRINCIPLES		
MAIN PRINCIPLES	SUB PRINCIPLES	DEFINITION
FINISH THE ATTACK CREATE SCORING OPPORTUNITY AND SCORE	Separate: time run or quick movement to unmark	- Move into a position in and around the box to score or assist: -Forward run behind the opponent's back line from a high position (attacking position) -Forward run behind the opponent's back line from a deeper position (midfield position) -Move out of sight to receive - Counter movement: opposite movement between two players - Quick movement from opponent to create space
	Final pass: through ball or combination play	- Disguised pass to manipulate opponent - Pass quickly, accurately and with appropriate pace: -through ball or chip ball to player who runs in behind -pass to unmarked player in or around the box - Quick combination play between 2 or more players to find a teammate in a goalscoring position - Recognize the player in the better position.
	Numbers in the box: fill zones in front of goal	- Efficient occupation of zones in the box on cross: near post, back post, penalty spot, edge of box -Time your run in the box. -Get unmarked or in front of opponent. -Attack the ball.
	Cross: into space or player	- Time the cross in front or behind the backline. - Recognize space (positioning of goalkeeper and defenders) -recognize the positions and runs of teammates in penalty box
	Take on 1v1 to create or score	Eliminate opponent through dribble to create goalscoring opportunity
	Finish: use limited touches	- Shoot from (short/long) distance. - Finish off the cross: choose your final touch. - React quickly on rebounds.



PLAYER DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK

11v11



U15 - U16

PROGRESSION PHASE II
SCANNING, RECEIVING, DRIBBLING, SHORT COMBINATION PLAY AND FINISHING

PLAYER ACTIONS
A soccer skill, needed to successfully execute a team tactical main- or sub-principle requiring perception, decision-making, physical and technical execution.
ATTACKING
WITH THE BALL
Controlling
Protecting
Driving
Dribbling
Passing
Shooting
SPACIAL & POSITIONAL AWARENESS
Scanning
Supporting
Adapting body shape

U15 - U16	
PROGRESSION PHASE II	
SCANNING, RECEIVING, DRIBBLING, SHORT COMBINATION PLAY AND FINISHING	
ATTACKING	
When we have the ball, we want to play forward through individual actions and short combinations, to play in the attacking half in order to create chances and score goals.	
PLAYER ACTIONS	
A soccer skill, needed to successfully execute a team tactical main- or sub-principle requiring perception, decision-making, physical and technical execution.	
PLAYER ACTION	DEFINITION
WITH THE BALL	
CONTROLLING	- Receiving and preparing the ball from short passes (distance of 5 to 20 yards) - Receiving and preparing the ball in such a way that you can immediately go to goal - Receiving and preparing the ball in such a way that it stays as close to you as possible - Receiving by moving towards the ball when opponent is close by (attacking the ball) - Receiving and preparing the ball from a long pass in the air - Receiving and preparing the ball on the bounce - Receiving and preparing the ball on the turn towards the opponent's goal as quickly as possible - Receiving and playing in 1 touch if you can pass accurately - Avoiding looking at the ball when receiving and preparing the ball - Scanning for a free teammate after performing the control - Scanning for a free teammate before or while receiving and preparing the ball - Avoiding a long ball from bouncing - receiving before the bounce - Receiving and playing a long ball in 1 touch if you can pass accurately
PROTECTING	- Shielding and maintaining possession of the ball, by placing most of the body between the ball and opponent, keeping the ball on the furthest foot away from the defender while looking for teammates - Turning away from and out of reach of your opponent
DRIVING	- Running with the ball, keeping the ball as close as possible to the body - Avoiding looking at the ball while driving the ball - Keeping your body between the ball and the approaching opponent while driving the ball - Running as fast as possible with the ball, picking up speed to gain as much time and territory as possible - Creating space in advance (before controlling) in which you want to drive the ball

U15 - U16	
PROGRESSION PHASE II	
SCANNING, RECEIVING, DRIBBLING, SHORT COMBINATION PLAY AND FINISHING	
ATTACKING	
When we have the ball, we want to play forward through individual actions and short combinations, to play in the attacking half in order to create chances and score goals.	
PLAYER ACTIONS	
A soccer skill, needed to successfully execute a team tactical main- or sub-principle requiring perception, decision-making, physical and technical execution.	
PLAYER ACTION	DEFINITION
WITH THE BALL	
DRIBBLING	• Taking on the opponent • Reading the body shape of the opponent and engaging on the most obvious/weak side • Accelerating when eliminating the opponent • Avoiding looking at the ball while dribbling • Keeping your body between the ball and the opponent while dribbling • Holding off the opponent and creating distance from the opponent • Dribbling through a change of direction at the right time, or through a change of speed or through a feint • Dribbling when you can cause direct danger on target
PASSING	• Playing the ball intentionally with different surfaces to a free teammate, into feet or space, within a distance of 5 to 20 yards • Playing the ball to the foot so that the player receiving the ball can continue to play forward • Making a leading pass in front of your teammate, making sure that the teammate can take the ball without having to slow down • Looking at the player you are passing to when passing • Trying to take out an opponent with a quick wall pass (give and go) in a small space • Making a long pass in the air • Playing a long ball in space so a teammate can receive the ball while running • Avoiding passing to a player surrounded by opponents who can be immediately put under pressure • Playing the cross at the right time and with the right ball speed outside the action area of the goalkeeper and the defender • Disguising the pass
SHOOTING	• Striking the ball intentionally with different surfaces from short and medium range (1-10 yards; 11-20 yards) on the goal (finishing) • Looking at the position of the goalkeeper before shooting at goal, and selecting a target • Aiming for the far side if you shoot from an angle and the goalkeeper is protecting near post • Finishing in 1 time/touch when closely marked • Finishing on the volley / bounce • Following the ball after the shot • Dribbling at the goalkeeper when he/she comes out at full speed or when he or she protects the goal well and scoring from the shot becomes difficult • Chipping the goalkeeper • Disguising the finish

U15 - U16	
PROGRESSION PHASE II	
SCANNING, RECEIVING, DRIBBLING, SHORT COMBINATION PLAY AND FINISHING	
ATTACKING	
When we have the ball, we want to play forward through individual actions and short combinations, to play in the attacking half in order to create chances and score goals.	
PLAYER ACTIONS	
A soccer skill, needed to successfully execute a team tactical main- or sub-principle requiring perception, decision-making, physical and technical execution.	
PLAYER ACTION	DEFINITION
SPACIAL & POSITIONAL AWARENESS	
SCANNING	- Searching for the ball, teammates and the goal: -Scanning for a free teammate after performing the control -Scanning for a free teammate before or while receiving and preparing the ball (passing) -Scanning and avoiding looking at the ball while dribbling -Scanning and looking at the position of the goalkeeper before shooting at goal, and selecting a target (shooting)
SUPPORTING (POSITIONING)	- Looking at the player in possession of the ball - Finding open space for self and indicating this, verbally or non-verbally, to the player in possession of the ball - Repositioning after giving a pass (ex. give and go) - Assessing teammates' movements and moving off each other - Unmarking and running behind opponent when a teammate on the ball is looking for options - Looking to get out of sight from the defender's vision - Losing direct opponent by switching positions with a teammate - Anticipating as the third player who will get the ball after a pass between two teammates
ADAPTING BODY SHAPE	- Adjusting shoulders and hips to be 45 - 90 degrees towards the attacking goal. - While approaching, have an optimal overview of the game situation.

U15 - U16						
PROGRESSION PHASE II						
SCANNING, RECEIVING, DRIBBLING, SHORT COMBINATION PLAY AND FINISHING						
ATTACKING						
When we have the ball, we want to play forward through individual actions and short combinations, to play in the attacking half in order to create chances and score goals.						
FIELD	PHASE	OBJECTIVE	TEAM TACTICAL PRINCIPLES		PLAYER ACTIONS	
			MAIN PRINCIPLES	SUB PRINCIPLES	WITH THE BALL	
DEFENDING HALF	BUILDING UP	• Advance the ball • Keep the ball	CREATE ATTACKING SHAPE	• Create appropriate height, width, depth • Create optimal attacking distances between players	• Controlling	
					• Protecting	
					• Driving	
			PROVIDE OPTIONS TO PLAY FORWARD	• Provide vertical or diagonal passing options • Create overload centrally or wide • Move or lose opponent when marked • Make runs behind the defensive line • Give immediate support to teammate under pressure	• Dribbling	
					• Passing	
					• Shooting	
ATTACKING HALF	CREATING & SCORING	• Score goal • Create chance • Advance the ball • Keep the ball	BREAK LINES TO ADVANCE ATTACK	• Drive with the ball to exploit space • Engage opponent: create 1v1 or 2v1 • Find a free player between or behind the lines • Switch play: pass the ball to the opponent’s weak zone	SPACIAL & POSITIONAL AWARENESS	
					• Scanning	
			TAKE COUNTERMEASURES: ANTICIPATE OPPONENT COUNTER	• Push up the defensive line with speed: stay connected and compact • Create high defensive shape behind the ball		• Supporting
			FINISH THE ATTACK	• Separate: time run or quick movement to unmark • Final pass: through ball or combination play • Numbers in the box: fill in zones in front of goal • Cross into space or player • Take on 1v1 to create or score • Finish: use limited touches		
			U.S. Soccer Player Development Framework Slide #183			



PLAYER DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK

11v11



U15 - U16

PROGRESSION PHASE II
SCANNING, RECEIVING, DRIBBLING, SHORT COMBINATION PLAY AND FINISHING

ATTACKING TO DEFENDING TRANSITION	
GAME IDEA	
When we lose the ball, we want to regain it early by reacting immediately with maximum intensity. When we recognize we are unable to pressure the ball, we recover quickly into a defending shape.	
TEAM TACTICAL PRINCIPLES	
MAIN PRINCIPLES	SUB PRINCIPLES
APPLY IMMEDIATE PRESSURE ON THE BALL	- Press to regain or prevent progress of the ball - Provide cover and balance: eliminate options
DELAY THE COUNTERATTACK	- Drop off and block direct path to goal - Slow down and dictate opponent
RECOVER WITH SPEED	- Get numbers back quickly and take defensive position - Press from behind as quickly as possible - Stay connected: look to win the second ball
TAKE COUNTERMEASURES: ANTICIPATE THE COUNTER	- Create passing option(s): between the lines - Create passing option(s): look to run in behind
DENY FINISH FROM COUNTERATTACK	- Defend the goal and create conditions to engage - Challenge to protect against a goal attempt

U15 - U16		
PROGRESSION PHASE II		
SCANNING, RECEIVING, DRIBBLING, SHORT COMBINATION PLAY AND FINISHING		
ATTACKING TO DEFENDING TRANSITION		
When we lose the ball, we want to regain it early by reacting immediately with maximum intensity. When we recognize we are unable to pressure the ball, we recover quickly into a defending shape.		
TEAM TACTICAL PRINCIPLES		
MAIN PRINCIPLES	SUB PRINCIPLES	DEFINITION
APPLY IMMEDIATE PRESSURE ON THE BALL REACT QUICKLY TO WIN THE BALL BACK AND STOP OPPONENTS' FORWARD PLAY	Press to regain or prevent progress of the ball	- Recognize situations when to press or hold and force wide (awareness). - Win the ball when opportunity to regain (distance, numbers and levels of compactness) - Nearest player(s): -React immediately, reduce space with speed and intensity -Apply (frontal/diagonal) pressure on the ball: deny switch - stop long ball - prevent forward pass -Stay disciplined: no foul
	Provide cover and balance: eliminate options	PROTECT THE NEAREST SPACE: ANTICIPATE SHORT PASSING - Teammates collectively reduce space and area around the ball - Mark outlet players - block passing lines - cover space - Push up the lines when opposition is forced backwards. PROTECT THE SPACE IN BEHIND: ANTICIPATE THE LONG BALL - Central defenders anticipate the long ball when inefficient pressure: read pass and drop - Wide defenders attach to the backline - Adjust body position to anticipate opponent's movement or action.
DELAY THE COUNTERATTACK DROP AND NARROW, REDUCE SPEED OF OPPONENTS TO ALLOW PLAYERS TO RECOVER	Drop off and block direct path to goal	- Drop-off and protect the center: -Drop centrally, get narrow and defend in relation to goal -Create compact block - numbers between ball and goal (to force play wide) - Reduce the central space between the backline. - Identify and mark the most dangerous player.
	Slow down and dictate opponent	- Slow down the opponent when we are unable to pressure the player on the ball and in a disadvantage (ex. outnumbered) to allow players to return in the defensive block. - Dictate direction (force backwards or wide) and speed of play (reduce speed). - Create equal numbers or overload (in area of the ball): eliminate passing options (2v1 → 1-1).

U15 - U16		
PROGRESSION PHASE II		
SCANNING, RECEIVING, DRIBBLING, SHORT COMBINATION PLAY AND FINISHING		
ATTACKING TO DEFENDING TRANSITION		
When we lose the ball, we want to regain it early by reacting immediately with maximum intensity. When we recognize we are unable to pressure the ball, we recover quickly into a defending shape.		
TEAM TACTICAL PRINCIPLES		
MAIN PRINCIPLES	SUB PRINCIPLES	DEFINITION
RECOVER WITH SPEED SPRINT BACK TO GET BALANCED, ORGANIZED AND APPLY PRESSURE	• Get numbers back quickly and take defensive position	• Sprint back to get behind the ball to support teammates. • Attach to the backline and defend in relation to the goal.
	• Press from behind as quickly as possible	• Sprint back and put pressure on the opponent in possession: -Prevent the opponent from playing forward or dribbling with the ball -Try to recover the ball (don't give up)
	• Stay connected: look to win the second ball	• Recover quickly to defend the long ball (create numbers around the ball). • Position or mark to prevent the opponent from playing forward after lay-off. • Pressure to regain the ball.
TAKE COUNTERMEASURES POSITION TO PREPARE THE COUNTERATTACK	• Create passing option(s): between the lines	• Anticipate the moment when team wins the ball back : -Stop defending -Unmark from defender -Position (diagonally) between the lines to set up a possible counter-attack
	• Create passing option(s): look to run in behind	• Anticipate the moment when team wins the ball back . • Stop defending and position to create the opportunity to make a run in behind the defensive line.
DENY FINISH FROM COUNTERATTACK DENY SCORING OPPORTUNITIY AND PREVENT SCORING	• Defend the goal and create conditions to engage	• Be patient and don't commit too early (recognize distance from goal, wait for teammates). • Isolate opponent on the ball when possible: 2v1 → 1-1
	• Challenge to protect against a goal attempt	• Challenge with strong determination: block shot to tackle - intercept to prevent assist -When we are organized and have a numerical advantage -When opponent is in shooting distance

U15 - U16					
PROGRESSION PHASE II					
SCANNING, RECEIVING, DRIBBLING, SHORT COMBINATION PLAY AND FINISHING					
ATTACKING TO DEFENDING TRANSITION					
When we lose the ball, we want to regain it early by reacting immediately with maximum intensity. When we recognize we are unable to pressure the ball, we recover quickly into a defending shape.					
FIELD	PHASE	OBJECTIVE	TEAM TACTICAL PRINCIPLES		PLAYER ACTIONS
			MAIN PRINCIPLES	SUB PRINCIPLES	AGAINST THE BALL
ATTACING HALF	PREVENTING BUILD UP	- Regain the ball - Prevent the opponent from playing forward - Deny penetration from the dribble - Reducing time and space	APPLY IMMEDIATE PRESSURE ON THE BALL	- Press to regain or prevent progress of the ball - Provide cover and balance: eliminate options	Intercepting
					Pressing
					Challenging
					Delaying
					Block the shot
DEFENDING HALF	DENYING CHANCES & SCORING	- Prevent goal - Deny a chance - Regain the ball - Prevent the opponent from playing forward - Deny penetration from the dribble - Reducing time and space	DELAY THE COUNTERATTACK	- Drop off and block direct path to goal - Slow down and dictate opponent	SPACIAL & POSITIONAL AWARENESS
					Scanning
			RECOVER WITH SPEED	- Get numbers back quickly and take defensive position - Press from behind as quickly as possible - Stay connected: look to win the second ball	Covering
			DENY THE FINISH	- Defend the goal and create conditions to engage - Challenge to protect against a goal attempt	Marking
			U.S. Soccer Player Development Framework Slide #187		



PLAYER DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK

11v11



U15 - U16

PROGRESSION PHASE II
SCANNING, RECEIVING, DRIBBLING, SHORT COMBINATION PLAY AND FINISHING

DEFENDING	
GAME IDEA	
When we do not have the ball, we want to prevent the opponent from playing forward and regain the ball as high up the field as possible through compactness and pressing.	
TEAM TACTICAL PRINCIPLES	
MAIN PRINCIPLES	SUB PRINCIPLES
CREATE DEFENDING SHAPE	- Make team compact: vertical and horizontal (Re-) Position to create a high front line (Re-) Position to create a high defensive line
	Create optimal defending distances between players
BUILD PRESSURE ON THE BALL	Move as a collective unit: make play predictable
	Initiate pressure on the opponent with the ball
	Engage when chance of regaining the ball
	Provide cover and balance: eliminate passing options
	Prevent the switch: keep opponent on one side
	Protect space in behind: anticipate long ball
RECOVER WHEN PRESSURE IS BROKEN	Immediately (re-) apply pressure on the ball
	Delay attack and regain defensive shape
	Look to intercept pass or win second ball
TAKE COUNTERMEASURES: ANTICIPATE TO COUNTER	Create passing option(s): between the lines
	Create passing option(s): look to run in behind
DENY THE FINISH	Get narrow and close the center: denying the through ball
	Marking and tracking opponent
	Deny the cross
	Defending the cross: protect the width of the goal
	Challenge to protect against goal attempt

U15 - U16		
PROGRESSION PHASE II		
SCANNING, RECEIVING, DRIBBLING, SHORT COMBINATION PLAY AND FINISHING		
DEFENDING		
When we do not have the ball, we want to prevent the opponent from playing forward and regain the ball as high up the field as possible through compactness and pressing.		
TEAM TACTICAL PRINCIPLES		
MAIN PRINCIPLES	SUB PRINCIPLES	DEFINITION
CREATE DEFENDING SHAPE POSITION TO CREATE COMPACT TEAM ORGANIZATION AND REDUCE SPACE	• Make team compact: vertical and horizontal - (Re-) Position to create a high front line - (Re-) Position to create a high defensive line	• Create a defensive block and reduce passing options for the opponent on the ball - as high as possible • Attacking players (re-)position to create a high line of confrontation • Position to block passing lanes, make play predictable and build pressure • Center backs and/or fullbacks take a high defending position to support compactness - Reduce space between different lines of the team - Manage offside: central defender closest to the ball creates the offside line (if in own half) • High position of the goalkeeper to stay connected with the backline
	• Create optimal defending distances between players	• Create relationships - connections between players through spacing and distances : - Reduce options to penetrate with the ball - Ensure cover - Allow for interception

U15 - U16		
PROGRESSION PHASE II		
SCANNING, RECEIVING, DRIBBLING, SHORT COMBINATION PLAY AND FINISHING		
DEFENDING		
When we do not have the ball, we want to prevent the opponent from playing forward and regain the ball as high up the field as possible through compactness and pressing.		
TEAM TACTICAL PRINCIPLES		
MAIN PRINCIPLES	SUB PRINCIPLES	DEFINITION
BUILD PRESSURE ON THE BALL CREATE CONDITIONS TO WIN THE BALL OR TO PREVENT FORWARD PLAY	Move as a collective unit: make play predictable	- Move relative to the position of the ball while maintaining optimal distances between players: - Reduce time and space for the opponent on the ball - Shift and slide: no crossover with nearest teammate - Step: when the the ball is played backwards or when pressure on the ball - Direct the player on the ball: - Reduce the options for the opponent on the ball and force to one area : - Block passing lanes - Allow passes to pressing area
	Initiate pressure on the opponent with the ball	- Nearest player pressures the ball: - Prevent opponent from playing forward - Limit time on the ball - Force opponent to look down - Force to make mistake
	Engage when chance of regaining the ball	- Engage in the identified situations: - Step out and intercept when possible: for example - slow pass, bad touch,... - 1v1: don't get eliminated by dribble, touch or pass
	Provide cover and balance: eliminate passing options	- Block immediate passing options when teammate puts pressure on the ball - Cover by the closest player to prevent forward passes / progression: mark, front or track - Weakside players move centrally - Bring numbers to the area / outnumber the opponent/bring numbers around the ball
	Prevent the switch: keep opponent on one side	- Bring numbers around the ball - Keep opponent locked and stop from getting out of the area
	Protect space in behind: anticipate long ball	- Anticipate the long ball behind the defensive line in case of inefficient pressure - Adjust body shape - Hold the line when pressure on the ball - Drop when no pressure on the ball

U15 - U16		
PROGRESSION PHASE II		
SCANNING, RECEIVING, DRIBBLING, SHORT COMBINATION PLAY AND FINISHING		
DEFENDING		
When we do not have the ball, we want to prevent the opponent from playing forward and regain the ball as high up the field as possible through compactness and pressing.		
TEAM TACTICAL PRINCIPLES		
MAIN PRINCIPLES	SUB PRINCIPLES	DEFINITION
RECOVER WHEN PRESSURE IS BROKEN RE-CREATE CONDITIONS TO WIN THE BALL AND REGAIN COMPACTNESS	• Immediately (re-) apply pressure on the ball	• Re-apply pressure on opponent when line is broken: - From behind: chase the player in possession and attempt to win the ball back without fouling - In front: step up and press when cover is present • Recover from switch of play: - Strong shift of the team when opponent was able to switch the play
	• Delay attack and regain defensive shape	• Slow down the opponent's attack : drop and narrow. • Reduce speed of opponent to allow teammates to recover. • Recover with numbers between the ball and the goal. - outnumber opponent when possible - get organized • Track and/or mark the most dangerous players.
	• Look to intercept pass or win second ball	• When the line is broken by the long ball: defending players - Drop and narrow together - Compete for the second ball
TAKE COUNTERMEASURES: ANTICIPATE TO COUNTER POSITION TO PREPARE THE COUNTERATTACK	• Create passing option(s): between the lines	• Anticipate the moment when team wins the ball back and set for transition : - Stop defending - Unmark from defender - Scan field and position (diagonally) between the lines to set up a possible counter-attack
	• Create passing option(s): look to run in behind	• Anticipate the moment when team wins the ball back . • Stop defending and position to create the opportunity to make a run in behind the defensive line.

U15 - U16		
PROGRESSION PHASE II		
SCANNING, RECEIVING, DRIBBLING, SHORT COMBINATION PLAY AND FINISHING		
DEFENDING		
When we do not have the ball, we want to prevent the opponent from playing forward and regain the ball as high up the field as possible through compactness and pressing.		
TEAM TACTICAL PRINCIPLES		
MAIN PRINCIPLES	SUB PRINCIPLES	DEFINITION
DENY THE FINISH PREVENT OPPONENT FROM SCORING AND CREATING SCORING OPPORTUNITIES	Get narrow and close the center: denying the through ball	- Always pressure the player on the ball: reduce time, space and options for the opponent on the ball - Prevent opponent from passing and making runs to receive behind the defensive line - Reduce space between teammates: narrow when closer to goal -Get numbers in the central areas -Always provide protection for center backs by fronting them -Drive opponent's offensive play towards wide areas
	Marking and tracking opponent	- Close marking of direct opponent in zone: -Split-vision: keep eye on ball and opponent - Change marking: -Scan your surroundings and communicate -Stay in your defensive zone when the opponent changes position -Pass on opponent to teammate or mark opponent coming from another zone - Switch to player-marking: when necessary, switch from zonal marking to player marking
	Deny the cross	- Defend the cross with support from midfielder or winger. -Deny cross into space or player. -Center backs stay in central position.
	Defending the cross: protect the width of the goal	- Get organized and increase the protection in front of the goal on the cross: -Weakside fullback is connecting to the backline -Occupy strategic zones - Close marking of direct opponent: -Split-vision: keep eye on ball and opponent - Challenge: be first on the ball -Aggressiveness
	Challenge to protect against goal attempt	- Engage and commit when chance of attempt on goal -Don't get eliminated by dribble -Block shot -Win the second ball -Clearance

U15 - U16	
PROGRESSION PHASE II	
SCANNING, RECEIVING, DRIBBLING, SHORT COMBINATION PLAY AND FINISHING	
DEFENDING	
When we do not have the ball, we want to prevent the opponent from playing forward and regain the ball as high up the field as possible through compactness and pressing.	
PLAYER ACTIONS	
A soccer skill, needed to successfully execute a team tactical main- or sub-principle requiring perception, decision-making, physical and technical execution.	
PLAYER ACTION	DEFINITION
AGAINST THE BALL	
INTERCEPTING	• Winning or deflecting the ball, if not stay in position • Deflecting an opponent's pass away from the intended target • Staying in possession of the ball after stealing it and continuing with an attacking action • Playing in one touch to a teammate • Intercepting the ball as high as possible (high point) on a long (high) ball
PRESSING	• Running to the opponent who is about to receive the ball (approx. 2 yards distance) while the ball is moving (to reduce the space for the opponent or force error) • Having fast approach but slow arrival • Approach is forcing into desired area
CHALLENGING	• Taking good defensive posture (on toes, knees are bent, staggered stance, ...) that allows to start the 1v1 in favorable conditions • Always look at the ball • Staying on your feet • Retaining possession of the ball after winning the duel • If you are eliminated, don't give up, challenge again immediately
DELAYING	• Slowing down, reducing speed from the opponent's action • Driving the player on the ball to the outside (away from goal)
BLOCK THE SHOT	• Getting in between the ball and the defending goal to redirect the ball away from goal

U15 - U16	
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SCANNING, RECEIVING, DRIBBLING, SHORT COMBINATION PLAY AND FINISHING	
DEFENDING	
When we do not have the ball, we want to prevent the opponent from playing forward and regain the ball as high up the field as possible through compactness and pressing.	
PLAYER ACTIONS	
A soccer skill, needed to successfully execute a team tactical main- or sub-principle requiring perception, decision-making, physical and technical execution.	
PLAYER ACTION	DEFINITION
SPACIAL & POSITIONAL AWARENESS	
SCANNING	Searching for the ball, nearest teammates and nearest opponents in relationship to the goal we are protecting
ADAPTING BODY SHAPE	Adjusting shoulders and hips to be 45 - 90 degrees towards the defending goal
COVERING	- Positioning at the appropriate distance from the challenging teammate, allowing to quickly put pressure again if needed - Preventing the opponent behind your back (between the lines) from being an option
MARKING	- Preventing direct opponent from receiving the ball in favorable circumstances by positioning next to the opponent (proactive stance) - Trying to look at both the ball and direct opponent - Mark closer when closer to goal.

U15 - U16					
PROGRESSION PHASE II					
SCANNING, RECEIVING, DRIBBLING, SHORT COMBINATION PLAY AND FINISHING					
DEFENDING					
When we do not have the ball, we want to prevent the opponent from playing forward and regain the ball as high up the field as possible through compactness and pressing.					
FIELD	PHASE	OBJECTIVE	TEAM TACTICAL PRINCIPLES		PLAYER ACTIONS
			MAIN PRINCIPLES	SUB PRINCIPLES	AGAINST THE BALL
ATTACING HALF	PREVENTING BUILD UP	- Regain the ball - Prevent the opponent from playing forward - Deny penetration from the dribble - Reducing time and space	CREATE DEFENDING SHAPE	- Make team compact: vertical and horizontal -(Re-) Position to create a high front line -(Re-) Position to create high defensive line - Create optimal defending distances between players	Intercepting
					Pressing
					Challenging
					Delaying
					Block the shot
DEFENDING HALF	DENYING CHANCES & SCORING	- Prevent goal - Deny a chance - Regain the ball - Prevent the opponent from playing forward - Deny penetration from the dribble - Reducing time and space	BUILD PRESSURE ON THE BALL	- Move as a collective unit: make play predictable - Initiate pressure on the opponent with the ball - Engage when chance of regaining the ball - Provide cover and balance: eliminate passing options - Prevent the switch: keep opponent on one side - Protect space in behind: anticipate long ball	SPACIAL & POSITIONAL AWARENESS
					Scanning
			RECOVER WHEN PRESSURE IS BROKEN	- Immediately (re-) apply pressure on the ball - Delay attack and regain defensive shape - Look to intercept pass or win second ball	Covering
			DENY THE FINISH	- Get narrow and close the center: denying the through ball - Marking and tracking opponent - Deny the cross - Defending the cross: protect the width of the goal - Challenge to protect against goal attempt	Marking
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PLAYER DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK

11v11



U15 - U16

PROGRESSION PHASE II
SCANNING, RECEIVING, DRIBBLING, SHORT COMBINATION PLAY AND FINISHING

DEFENDING TO ATTACKING TRANSITION	
GAME IDEA	
When we regain the ball, we immediately think and play forward, look to attack at maximum speed in order to create chances and score goals. When we recognize we cannot play forward, we keep the ball and move into our attacking shape.	
TEAM TACTICAL PRINCIPLES	
MAIN PRINCIPLES	SUB PRINCIPLES
PLAY FORWARD QUICKLY	- First action forward - Continue to play forward
SECURE THE BALL	- Play out of pressure - Keep the ball and initiate build up
JOIN THE ATTACK WITH SPEED	- Provide support in front of the ball - Provide as much width as necessary - Provide support behind the ball
TAKE COUNTERMEASURES : ANTICIPATE THE COUNTER	- Push up the defensive line with speed: stay connected and compact - Create prevention shape behind the ball
FINISH THE COUNTERATTACK AS FAST AS POSSIBLE	Create and exploit space for self or teammate
	Attack space or engage opponent
	- Recognize player in a better position to score - Finish: use limited touches

U15 - U16		
PROGRESSION PHASE II		
SCANNING, RECEIVING, DRIBBLING, SHORT COMBINATION PLAY AND FINISHING		
DEFENDING TO ATTACKING		
When we regain the ball, we immediately think and play forward, look to attack at maximum speed in order to create chances and score goals. When we recognize we cannot play forward, we keep the ball and move into our attacking shape.		
TEAM TACTICAL PRINCIPLES		
MAIN PRINCIPLES	SUB PRINCIPLES	DEFINITION
PLAY FORWARD QUICKLY PLAY FORWARD WITH AS FEW PASSES AS POSSIBLE	• First action forward	- Start attacking transition immediately with forward action: - Pass forward into open space or feet to (highest) transition player (vertical / diagonal) - Touch forward and run or dribble aggressively at maximum speed when space - GK distribution: throw/volley into space or feet
	• Continue to play forward	- Continue to progress the ball forward at speed to prevent the opponent from returning into defensive shape: dribble or pass - Play with limited touches to increase the speed of the transition: - Direct: open body shape to receive the ball facing forward or turn when time on the ball - Indirect: lay-off / playing backwards to supporting teammate (3rd man running) - Stay central if possible - Take advantage of space behind the opponent's backline - pass behind
SECURE THE BALL ESCAPE COUNTERPRESS FROM CLOSEST OPPONENT(S)	• Play out of pressure	- Shield the ball when pressure from opponent - Move the ball out of the zone when possession is regained to escape counter press - Play sideways or backwards when unable to dribble or pass forward (or draw foul)
	• Keep the ball: initiate build up	- Keep possession when opponent is balanced and organized - Recognize risk vs reward: priority is to secure possession - Move into attacking shape
JOIN THE ATTACK WITH SPEED SPRINT FORWARD TO ATTACK OR SUPPORT	• Provide support in front of the ball	- Sprint forward and commit numbers into the attacking half - Get players in front of the ball as quickly as possible to attack the backline of the opponent - Provide a passing option: make a run in behind
	• Provide as much width as possible	- Occupy all three central-vertical channels - Restrict runs to width of penalty area, when possible, to facilitate quick passing, limit risk of interception, and create direct chance on goal
	• Provide support behind the ball	- Position to enable the attack to continue by creating passing options behind the ball - Recycle the attack when unable to continue the counter

U15 - U16		
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SCANNING, RECEIVING, DRIBBLING, SHORT COMBINATION PLAY AND FINISHING		
DEFENDING TO ATTACKING		
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TEAM TACTICAL PRINCIPLES		
MAIN PRINCIPLES	SUB PRINCIPLES	DEFINITION
TAKE COUNTERMEASURES: ANTICIPATE THE COUNTER POSITION TO PROTECT AGAINST COUNTERATTACK	Push up the defensive line with speed: stay connected and compact	- Provide balance (numbers). - Close space in between lines that the opponent could exploit. - Create as high a line as possible.
	Create prevention shape behind the ball	- Defensive positioning with a specific amount of players -Defend the center of the field: block passing lines -Lock down the opponent's outlet(s): mark transition players -GK take high position: stay connected with the backline
FINISH THE COUNTERATTACK AS FAST AS POSSIBLE CREATE SCORING OPPORTUNITY AND SCORE	Create and exploit space for self or teammate	- Separate from opponent and receive between the lines. - Exploit space behind opponent backline: make a run to receive in behind. - Make a run to free up space for teammate to receive.
	Attack space or engage opponent	- Dribble at speed into open space: -Invite pressure to create (more) space for teammate(s) - Dribble at speed to isolate defender: -Attract to free up teammate (2v1) -Eliminate defender or create separation and shoot (1v1)
	Recognize player in a better position to score	- Keep composure (decision at full speed) - Recognize the right moment to pass to a teammate in a better position to score or assist - We attack/occupy different areas in the box
	Finish: use limited touches	Select the best surface and shoot on goal with a minimal touches.

U15 - U16					
PROGRESSION PHASE II					
SCANNING, RECEIVING, DRIBBLING, SHORT COMBINATION PLAY AND FINISHING					
DEFENDING TO ATTACKING					
When we regain the ball, we immediately think and play forward, look to attack at maximum speed in order to create chances and score goals.					
When we recognize we cannot play forward, we keep the ball and move into our attacking shape.					
FIELD	PHASE	OBJECTIVE	TEAM TACTICAL PRINCIPLES		PLAYER ACTIONS
			MAIN PRINCIPLES	SUB PRINCIPLES	WITH THE BALL
DEFENDING HALF	BUILDING UP	• Advance the ball • Keep the ball	PLAY FORWARD QUICKLY	• First action forward • Continue to play forward	• Controlling
			SECURE THE BALL	• Play out of pressure • Keep the ball and initiate build up	• Protecting
					• Driving
					• Dribbling
ATTACKING HALF	CREATING & SCORING	• Score goal • Create chance • Advance the ball • Keep the ball	JOIN THE ATTACK WITH SPEED	• Provide support in front of the ball • Provide as much width as possible • Provide support behind the ball	• Passing
			TAKE COUNTERMEASURES: ANTICIPATE THE COUNTER	• Push up the defensive line with speed: stay connected and compact • Create prevention shape behind the ball	• Shooting
					SPACIAL & POSITIONAL AWARENESS
			FINISH THE COUNTERATTACK	• Create and exploit space for self or teammate • Attack space or engage the opponent • Recognize player in better position to score • Finish: use limited touches	• Scanning
					• Supporting
					• Adapting body shape

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